

August 2026 — Digital Advertising Report

Search Engine Advertising + Retargeting — Fourth Full Month

Period: August 1 – August 31, 2026 **Reporting date:** September 18, 2026

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August marks the program's **fourth full calendar month** of delivery, and the trend line continued to move steadily upward: **qualified phone calls and conversion efficiency both edged higher while overall search volume remained controlled.** Impressions rose 2.8% and clicks 2.9% versus July — while phone-call leads climbed from 31 to **32** and the conversion rate held at **11.3%**, its highest level to date. Growth has settled into the steadier rhythm expected as the account moves beyond the initial learning period and Google's bidding continues to narrow in on the searches most likely to produce a call.

August delivered **32 verifiable phone-call leads through Google Search**, plus 28 secondary touchpoints (19 phone calls dialed from the website after an ad click, and 9 form submissions) — **60 tracked search interactions** in all, up from 58 in July. The retargeting layers also began operating during August, giving Guardian an additional layer of visibility among homeowners who had already visited the site.

1. Executive Summary

KPIs below reflect the **core Google Search program** — the whole of August's Search delivery — for clean month-over-month comparison against July and the preceding months.

PHONE-CALL LEADS

32

▲ +3.2% vs July (31) · 60s+ qualified

LONG-DURATION CALLS
(90S+)

23

▲ +4.5% vs July (22)

PHONE SHARE

85%

All phone actions ÷ all tracked leads

IMPRESSIONS

35,058

▲ +2.8% vs July (34,103)

CLICKS

283

▲ +2.9% vs July · CTR 0.81%

CONV. RATE

11.3%

Highest of the program to date

Headline: four straight months of rising call volume, with August maintaining the gradual upward trend rather than producing a sharp jump. Phone-call leads have gone **15 → 23 → 29 → 31 → 32** since the program launched in April, while impressions and clicks have remained comparatively controlled. The account continues to focus on buying better-qualified traffic rather than simply expanding click volume.

2. Conversion Performance

SOURCE	COUNT	NOTES
Calls from Google Ads (primary — 60s+ qualified)	32	The primary conversion metric. Up from 31 in July. A call from someone who clicked a Google ad and stayed on the line past the 60-second qualifying threshold.
Calls from Google Ads — long-duration subset (90s+)	23	Subset of the above (up from 22). Conversations lasting 90+ seconds — a strong signal the call moved past initial qualifying into a real discussion.
Call clicks from website (secondary)	19	Visitor clicked a Google ad, landed on the site, then dialed the number on the page. Tracked as a secondary action.
Form submissions (secondary)	9	Email-form leads. Treated as secondary per program design — this lead type converts to booked appointments at a lower rate than phone calls.
Total tracked interactions (Search)	60	32 primary phone-call leads + 28 secondary touchpoints. Up from 58 in July.

Twenty-three of the thirty-two primary calls ran past ninety seconds — **72% of them**, slightly above July's 71% proportion. The ratio remained essentially stable while total primary call volume increased, which indicates that the incremental activity continued to produce substantive homeowner conversations rather than simply additional short-duration calls.

Each qualified conversion also continues to feed back into the bidding model, giving Google additional performance history around the searches, devices, and audiences that produce meaningful calls.

3. Campaign Performance

CAMPAIGN	IMPR.	CLICKS	CTR	CONV.	CONV. RATE
SRCH — Foundation Repair	20,447	123	0.60%	16	13.0%
SRCH — Water + Crawl	13,819	105	0.76%	13	12.4%
SRCH — Branded	792	55	6.94%	3	5.5%
Total	35,058	283	0.81%	32	11.3%

Conversion counts reflect **primary phone-call leads only**. The 19 website call clicks and 9 form submissions are tracked but not counted in the primary totals, per the program's primary-vs-secondary design.

- **Foundation Repair** — 16 phone-call leads at a 13.0% conversion rate, up from 15 at 12.5%. It remained the largest campaign by impression volume and the biggest absolute contributor. Its 0.60% click-through rate continues to reflect the intentionally narrow keyword structure: tight match types and negative-keyword filtering keep the campaign concentrated around commercial-intent searches.
- **Water + Crawl** — 13 leads at a 12.4% conversion rate, holding essentially steady against July's 13 leads at 12.9%. Basement waterproofing and crawl-space encapsulation continued to generate consistent commercial-intent activity, with the campaign maintaining a substantial share of the account's qualified calls.
- **Branded** — 3 leads at 5.5%, with a 6.94% click-through rate. The campaign continues to defend the Guardian name inexpensively and remains a useful indicator of branded search activity among homeowners already familiar with the company.

Device performance

DEVICE	IMPR.	CLICKS	CONV.
Mobile	23,491	183	22
Desktop	10,603	91	10
Tablet	964	9	0
Total	35,058	283	32

Mobile again produced the majority of primary calls — **22 of 32** — with desktop contributing 10. The split remained consistent with the established account pattern, reflecting the behavior of homeowners who notice a crack, moisture problem, or other foundation issue and search from a phone.

The mobile bid adjustment stays in place, with continued emphasis on the search terms and hours that have produced the strongest call history.

4. Keyword Match-Type Performance

MATCH TYPE	IMPR.	CLICKS	CTR	CONV.	CONV. RATE
EXACT	10,843	113	1.04%	23	20.4%
PHRASE	24,215	170	0.70%	9	5.3%
Total	35,058	283	0.81%	32	11.3%

The exact-match advantage continued in August: exact-match keywords converted at **20.4%** against 5.3% for phrase match. Exact terms generated **23 of the month's 32 calls** from just under one-third of total impressions.

Phrase match continues to earn its place by capturing the real-world variations homeowners use when describing foundation, waterproofing, and crawl-space problems. Its conversion rate remained close to July's 5.5%, while exact-match terms continued to receive the strongest emphasis where proven call history exists.

Bidding continues to lean toward the exact terms with established call records while phrase match provides controlled expansion into additional commercial-intent searches.

5. Weather & Demand Backdrop

Ground conditions remained an important demand driver throughout August. The combination of summer rainfall events following a comparatively dry first half of the year continued to create the type of fluctuating soil-moisture conditions that can expose foundation movement, drainage problems, and crawl-space moisture issues.

Why it matters: East Tennessee's clay-heavy soils respond to changes in moisture by contracting and expanding. Homeowners may not notice the underlying soil movement immediately, but visible symptoms — cracks, sticking doors, uneven floors, damp crawl spaces, or new moisture intrusion — can prompt a search once the problem becomes noticeable.

That seasonal behavior continued to provide a supportive demand backdrop for the account. Search activity remained concentrated around high-intent repair, waterproofing, and crawl-space terms rather than broad home-improvement research.

6. Retargeting — First Month

The three retargeting channels began operating in August alongside the established Google Search program. July provides the clean Search-only baseline, while August provides the first month in which the additional audience layers were active.

The purpose was straightforward: keep Guardian visible to homeowners who had already demonstrated interest while continuing to use Search as the primary acquisition engine.

RETARGETING

Google Demand Gen — Remarketing

What it did: showed Guardian cards across YouTube, Gmail, and Discover to people who had previously viewed a service, contact, or financing page — keeping the name in front of them through the consideration window.

Why it matters: a homeowner researching foundation work often takes multiple visits before contacting a contractor. Demand Gen kept Guardian visible between those visits and encouraged additional return engagement.

RETARGETING

Meta (Facebook + Instagram) — Remarketing

What it did: reached the same site-visitor audience across Facebook and Instagram, extending Guardian's presence beyond Google.

Why it matters: it adds a second surface to the same warm audience and provides additional opportunities for return visits, form activity, and direct brand recognition when homeowners are ready to act.

AWARENESS / FEEDER

Meta — Cold Prospecting (Feeder)

What it did: put the Guardian name in front of Knox-metro homeowners who had not visited the site yet. Its job was to feed the remarketing audience rather than generate immediate direct leads.

Why it matters: the two remarketing layers can only work against an audience that exists. This builds that audience and is judged primarily on audience growth and subsequent engagement rather than immediate lead volume.

What to expect: retargeting rarely shows its full value in the first month. August established the initial audience and performance baseline, while September and October will provide a larger pool of returning visitors against which to measure the contribution.

7. Google Business Profile — Organic Context

Separate from the paid program, Guardian's Google Business Profile — the free listing that appears in Google Maps and local search — continued to generate meaningful organic activity during August. Total profile interactions rose from 153 in July to **157** in August, an increase of approximately 2.6%.

Both tracked action types moved modestly:

ACTION FROM THE GOOGLE LISTING	JULY	AUGUST	CHANGE
Website clicks	67	69	+3.0%
Phone calls	46	47	+2.2%
Total profile interactions	153	157	+2.6%

Website clicks from the listing increased slightly from 67 to 69, while phone calls from the listing moved from 46 to 47. The overall profile continued to provide a steady secondary source of local discovery and direct engagement.

Worth noting: this is organic visibility, entirely distinct from the paid call totals reported above, and it should not be added to them. It is nevertheless a useful complementary signal. As Guardian maintains its paid presence across the market, the Google Business Profile continues to capture people who discover or return to the business through local organic search.

8. September Outlook

The program has now moved beyond the initial learning period and into a stage where accumulated conversion history can be used to continue refining bidding, keyword allocation, and audience targeting.

On the Search side, the priorities remain unchanged: keep Foundation Repair and Water + Crawl accumulating call-conversion history, maintain strong coverage on exact-match terms with proven call records, and use phrase match to identify additional commercial-intent variations.

The retargeting program is now active and has its first month of baseline data. September provides an opportunity to build that audience further and determine where repeat visitors and returning site users

are showing the strongest engagement.

Late summer into early fall remains an important period for foundation and crawl-space inquiries. Homeowners who noticed cracks, drainage problems, or moisture during the summer often begin researching repair options before the wetter fall and winter months.

On track: phone-call leads have risen every month since launch — **15, 23, 29, 31, 32** — with the conversion rate climbing from 7.8% to 9.2%, 11.1%, and 11.3%, where it has now held for a second month at the program's best level. August continued the gradual improvement established over the previous months, with qualified call volume increasing while overall traffic remained tightly controlled. The account continues to build conversion history in the areas most likely to produce meaningful homeowner conversations.